

Writing Text Data To Files In Java

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What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can use the `FileWriter` class to write and save text data to a file.

Before We Start

When you type information in a program, what happens to the information after the program closes?

How can a program save information so it can be opened again later?

Let's Understand

Java programs can display information on the screen, but the displayed information normally disappears when the program closes.

A program can save information permanently by writing it to a file.

Java provides the `FileWriter` class for writing text data to a file.

```
import java.io.FileWriter;
import java.io.IOException;
```

The basic steps for writing text data are:

1. Create a `FileWriter` object.
2. Use the `write()` method to add text.
3. Use the `close()` method to save and close the file.

```
FileWriter writer = new FileWriter("message.txt");

writer.write("Hello, Java!");

writer.close();
```

The file name is written inside the parentheses:

```
new FileWriter("message.txt");
```

The `write()` method places text inside the file:

```
writer.write("Hello, Java!");
```

The `close()` method finishes the writing process and releases the file:

```
writer.close();
```

The main method may include `throws IOException` because an error may happen while Java is creating or writing the file.

```
public static void main(String[] args) throws IOException
```

After running the program, Java creates the text file inside the project folder.

Let's Practice

Create a Java program named `SaveMessage`.

The program must create a file named `my-message.txt` and write the following lines:

```
Welcome to Java programming.  
Java can save text data to files.
```

After running the program, locate and open `my-message.txt` to check its contents.

Challenge Task

Create a program named `StudentRecordWriter`.

The program must:

- Ask the user to enter their name.
- Ask the user to enter their grade and section.
- Ask the user to enter their favorite subject.
- Display the entered information clearly on the screen.
- Save the information in a file named `student-record.txt`.
- Place each piece of information on a separate line.
- Close the file after writing the information.

Expected file format:

```
STUDENT RECORD  
Name: Maria Santos  
Grade and Section: Grade 11 - Java  
Favorite Subject: Computer Programming
```

Do not use `if`, `else`, or loops.

Resources / References

- Java `FileWriter` class
- Java `IOException` class
- Java `Scanner` class
- Text editor for opening generated `.txt` files